

Tiago Pontes Ferraz

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I am an applied economist specializing in labor economics, migration, and cultural change. My research uses quasi-experimental methods and large-scale administrative, spatial, and remote sensing data to study how population mobility shapes labor markets, inequality, religious change, and urbanization in Brazil and other developing economies.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Applied Microeconomics, Labor Economics, Migration, Religion and Cultural Change

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Mar 2026 – Present	Lecturer, SÃO PAULO SCHOOL OF ECONOMICS, EESP/FGV <i>Courses: Introduction to Economics (undergraduate)</i>
Mar 2026 – Present	Lecturer, MACKENZIE PRESBYTERIAN UNIVERSITY <i>Courses: Financial Mathematics, Topics in Economic Theory, and Topics in Econometrics (undergraduate)</i>
Jan 2025 – Present	Researcher, CENTRO DE ESTUDOS DA RELIGIÃO E POLÍTICAS PÚBLICAS (CERP), FEA-USP
Nov 2020 – Jan 2025	Researcher, LEPES, FEARP-USP
Feb 2016 – Jun 2020	Research Assistant, FEA-USP, São Paulo <i>Supervisors: Prof. Raphael Corbi and Prof. Fernanda Estevan</i>
Feb 2015 – Jun 2020	Teaching Assistant, FEA-USP <i>Courses: Microeconomics and Econometrics (graduate and undergraduate)</i>

EDUCATION

JAN 2018 – JUL 2023	PhD in Economics, Universidade de São Paulo , São Paulo <i>“Three Essays in Economics of Internal Migration”</i> <i>Award: Haralambos Simeonidis Best Dissertation, 2024</i>
JAN 2014 - OCT 2016	Masters in Economics, Universidade de São Paulo , São Paulo <i>“Benefit Sharing Exploring Water Resources in Brazil”</i>
JAN 2001 – DEC 2005	Bachelor in Economics, Universidade Anhembi-Morumbi , São Paulo

PUBLICATIONS

Internal Migration and Labor Market Adjustments in the Presence of Non-Wage Compensation (with Renata Narita, and Raphael Corbi). *Journal of Development Economics*, 2025.

WORKING PAPERS

The Industrial Organization of Belief: Market Size, Church Expansion and Religious Change (with Raphael Corbi, and Fabio Miessi).

Media coverage: *Folha de São Paulo*, Jan 2026.

Women's Career and Care Responsibilities: The Role of Migrant Domestic Workers in Brazil (with Renata Narita, Delia Furtado, and Raphael Corbi). New draft coming soon.

Criminal Peace: The Impact of Organized Crime Hegemony on Homicide Reduction in Brazil (with Giovanna Quintão, Erica Reis, and Luiz Scorzafave).

WORK IN PROGRESS

Internal Migration and Slum Expansion in Brazil (with Raphael Corbi)

Internal Migration and Redistribution: Evidence from Brazil (with Fernanda Almeida)

Entertainment Media Can Influence Migration Decisions: Evidence from Brazilian Soap Operas (with Raphael Corbi)

Migration and Occupational Risks in Brazilian Local Labor Markets

Cash Transfers and Labor Supply: Effects of a Large-Scale Emergency Program in Brazil (with Rodrigo Megale and Renato Vieira)

GRANTS AND AWARDS

2024 | Haralambos Simeonidis Best Dissertation Award

2018 – 2021 | CNPq and FAPESP Doctoral Research Grant

2014 – 2016 | CAPES Masters Research Grant

REFeree ACTIVITIES

IZA Journal of Development and Migration, Revista Brasileira de Economia, Pesquisa e Planejamento Econômico

SOFTWARE

Stata, R, Python

LANGUAGES

Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Italian (intermediate)